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- Official floor video (House of Delegates archive, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dBj1dNIQx2s
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[00:26:02] The House will come to order. Sergeant-at-Arms. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:26:19] The members will rise and be led in prayer by Reverend Ralph S. Hodge, Second Baptist Church, Richmond. It remains standing for the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Good afternoon. Let us bow our heads in reverence.

[00:26:37] Gracious and almighty God, this is a day that you have made, and we shall rejoice and be glad in it. Lord, we offer you praise and thanksgiving for who you are and what you have done. We give you praise ahead of time for all the things that you will do that the eyes have not seen and ears have not heard.

[00:26:54] We thank you for liberty. We praise you for a creation that declares how great you are. So as we come before your throne of grace, forgive us for any thought, action, word, or deed that is not aligned with your love and your justice. Let us tune our hearts and minds to your wisdom and your mercy.

[00:27:15] Empty us of all pride, arrogance, and remove all malice and strife. Break down walls of hostility and division. And let this body govern with kindness and thoughtfulness for the least of these. Let

them steward the people's resources in a way that fosters more affordable housing, less waste, safer communities, greater access to health care, and greater educational opportunities.

[00:27:38] Let this body seek the betterment of the Commonwealth as opposed to the wishes and desires of the rich and powerful. Guide them with compassion for others and not self-interest. Allow this group of legislators to create laws that assist the needy while correcting laws that disenfranchise the less powerful.

[00:27:56] Let love reign in their hearts. Let love guide their thoughts. And let love center their work. In your name we pray. Amen.

[00:28:20] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:28:46] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuit to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the Journal of House of Delegates for Monday, June 22, 2026. Motions of resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order.

[00:29:03] Clerks shall announce the first morning our order of business, including any clerks' announcements and communications. No announcements or communications at this point. So, therefore, this first portion of the morning are pursuant to House Rule 40. Speaker, request or use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board.

[00:29:19] The delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I have our eyes for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, joining us for our invocation today is Pastor Ralph Stephen Hodge of Second Baptist Church, South Richmond. I would ask that he please stand if he's still in the gallery.

[00:29:39] Okay. That's a first. Originally, well, I'll read it for the record. Originally from Fort Washington, Maryland, Pastor Hodge holds a bachelor's degree from Howard University and a Master of Divinity from Virginia Union University.

[00:30:02] Pastor Hodge has served our community as senior pastor of Second Baptist Church for the past 23 years. Under his leadership, the church has created one of Richmond's largest urban farms and the Broad Rock Farmers Market, expanding access to fresh food while creating opportunities for local farmers to sell their products.

[00:30:20] During the COVID-19 pandemic, Second Baptist Church became the first community hub in Virginia to provide space for testing and vaccinations, earning recognition from both this body and the United States Senate. Pastor Hodge also serves as vice president of Richmonders Involved to Strengthen Communities, where he was advocated for affordable housing and health care funding.

[00:30:41] Since 1997, he has also helped thousands of students as a math interventionist in Henrico County Public Schools. He and his wife are the proud parents of four adult sons. Whoever he is, I would like to thank him for giving our invocation today and ask that we give him a warm house welcome.

[00:30:58] Welcome wherever you are. The delegate from Camel County, delegate's there. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of a motion.

[00:31:17] The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I ask that we take up out of order House Resolution 2195. Clerk will report a resolution. A memorial resolution is laid on the speaker's table. House Resolution

2195, celebrating the life of Robert Stouffer. Mr. Speaker, Bob Stouffer gave himself to the establishment of Eastlake Community Church.

[00:31:37] His example in his life led many to better follow Jesus Christ, to live a life of love and good works. His life was an example and encouragement to the entire Moneta community. Just two weeks ago, he was with the community celebrating that church's 20th birthday when a sudden storm collapsed to the 1,500-person capacity tent they were in.

[00:31:58] That collapse killed Bob and sent 22 others to the hospital. Bob's death sent shockwaves through the community, and our honor and recognition of Bob's life will go a long way toward helping that community heal, that church and that family as well, to heal.

[00:32:15] Therefore, I ask that we adopt this resolution and that when we adjourn, we do so in honor and memory of Bob Stouffer. The delegate from Campbell County, Delegate Zerb, moves that the House adopt House Resolution 2195, celebrating the life of Robert Stouffer, and that when the House adjourned today, it do so in the honor and memory of Robert Stouffer.

[00:32:35] All those in favor of the motion shall please rise. The motion is agreed to. Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh.

[00:32:53] Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Would the students from the 26th District and surrounding areas please rise? Mr. Speaker, it's my pleasure to introduce the body to students from high schools and colleges who live in and around the 26th District who have joined us here today.

[00:33:09] I had the pleasure of working with them this summer. They represent high school's independence, Stonebridge, Light Ridge, George C. Marshall, and are attending George Washington University, Penn State, Northeastern, Virginia Tech, and some aspire to go to other schools as well. I've had the pleasure of working with them this summer.

[00:33:26] They are bright. They're enthusiastic. They're going to do great things. Please join us. Please join me in giving them a warm House welcome.

[00:33:42] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Pursuing to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are way on pressing personal business on a granted leave from today's session. Doug, it's Clark, Henson, Rasul, Sebo, Tata, Ward, Ware, Watts, Willett, and Williams.

[00:33:58] I think that's a quorum. Clerk shall announce the next order of business. The second portion of the morning hour is not applicable given today's calendar. Clerk will announce the next order. Third portion of the morning hour, remember, requests for legislation to go by for the day. I'm not aware of any such requests.

[00:34:14] The clerk shall announce it next. And the fourth and final portion of the morning hour is reserved for points of personal privilege. Kindly use your request speak button to get into the queue. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate McPike. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, and happy Pride. This month, LGBTQ plus residents in every community of our Commonwealth have been celebrating the progress we've made towards building a more equal Virginia and the emotion at the heart of the movement for full equality, hope.

[00:34:41] In 1978, Harvey Milk called upon us to offer hope to future generations, saying, and the young gay people who are coming out, the only thing they have to look forward to is hope. And you have to give

them hope. Hope for a better world. Hope for a better tomorrow. Hope that all will be right.

[00:34:57] It wasn't always easy to find hope in Virginia. Like many states, Virginia once explicitly denied LGBTQ plus people equal protection under the law. Countless people came of age at a time when coming out could cost you your job, your home, and even your family. It took hope to push through those dark days towards a brighter dawn, but that dawn did come.

[00:35:18] And it came because everyday Virginians came together and organized. It came because people were brave enough to be honest about who they were, even at times when that wasn't always safe. It came because parents and friends and religious leaders and educators and business owners weren't willing to allow people they cared about be treated as less than equal under the law.

[00:35:35] It came about because voters began electing LGBTQ plus Virginians to public office, starting with Jay Fassett of Arlington at the local level and Adam Eben of Virginia, right here in the General Assembly. Grassroots organizing and representation has turned the hope of pride into progress to be proud of.

[00:35:52] In 1988, Alexandria became the first locality in Virginia to ban discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation. In 2020, Virginia became the first state in the South to enact comprehensive civil rights protections for its LGBTQ plus residents. and those Virginians can count on this house, this general assembly, and this governor to stand by those rights. We have a lot to be proud of in Virginia, but our work isn't done, and this November we can take another step forward. We can remove a stain from our state's constitution by repealing the ban on marriages like mine and replacing it with an affirmative right to marriage equality. We can ensure that Virginia's constitution reflects our commonwealth's values and turn the hope that is at the heart of pride into security for thousands of families across

[00:36:31] Virginia. So happy pride, Mr. Speaker. Now that you're celebrating in June, let's pass the marriage equality amendment in November. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Thank you, Mr.

[00:36:58] Speaker. I rise on point of personal privilege. Delegate has to parole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. It is not something I enjoy when I have, I think, the duty to say I told you so. What I would enjoy more is not watching a lawmaking body violate the laws upon which it was built to begin with.

[00:37:22] And it is very hard for me and maybe for some of my colleagues to not adopt a sense of resignation when acknowledged with the mathematical realities of 64, 36 and parties that seem to tend to oftentimes vote lockstep.

[00:37:41] But I've been given the great honor and responsibility by my constituents to come down here and make the argument. And so I rise to do that today amongst the bills that we will consider is one involving the right to transport firearms in public. And I would submit that we are in violation, even contemplating this, of the Bruin decision.

[00:38:02] With that said, I would submit that there are many other bills that we have passed this General Assembly session that put us in violation of the Heller decision. With that said, we've done it anyway. It harkens back to Andrew Jackson, who said something to the effect of, they've made their ruling, now let us see them enforce it.

[00:38:21] And so we see where private citizens are forced to litigate for their God-given freedoms with their government, a terrible paradigm in which the private citizens are forced to pay not only for their

own attorneys, but for the attorneys of the government. And so then when the government looks at the bills and sees the briefs and sees the suits filed and then tries to adjust the bills, it's particularly onerous. I find it offensive, not as a delegate, but as a private citizen.

[00:38:48] So, here we are. Now, to make the argument, I want to simplify this. The argument I hear most frequently is, but why would you need to own weapons like X or Y or Z?

[00:39:05] So let me see if I can make this very clear. Why would the police need to own weapons like X or Y or Z? Can anybody in this room not answer that question? I think everybody in this room understands that the police might be forced to confront evil, might be forced to confront violence, but so too might we, and I will shock you perhaps with the truth that is the reality of 911 response times. In a rural area, it might be 30 to 60 minutes. There are 494 square miles of land in the county I grew up in, and at any given point, there are four patrol deputies, who, if there's a traffic accident,

[00:39:42] might be all in one spot. In an urban area or a suburban area, five to 15 minutes is considered an effective and good response time, and the Supreme Court of the United States and Newcastle I'm sorry, and Castle Rock Viganzales already ruled that even though the government has made a law, for example, in that case, a protective order saying that a father couldn't abscond with three children and then subsequently murder them, they can't be held liable for not upholding that law.

[00:40:09] So our government has told its citizens that we have a duty to protect you, but if we don't do it, there's no recourse. And so the police are given the most common patrol rifle in police service, the AR-15, because they might have to confront violent people.

[00:40:24] but so too are we as citizens. The handguns that our law enforcement professionals carry are banned as well, and we can look at reality to determine the results of what happens when people are disarmed. Charles Stedman Spinagel, in the county where I was at the time, prosecutor, had had like 112 911 dispatches to his home over the course of a period of years, and yet it still took law enforcement 15 minutes to show up, and because there was an active shooting in process, they wouldn't go in alone, so they had to wait another five minutes for a second unit to show up.

[00:41:03] The outcome of the disarmed members of the family that lived adjacent was one dead, one shot through and through, and another who ran to the police when they finally did arrive and was shot and killed by Mr. Spenagel, because why? They didn't have the weapons that they needed to defend themselves, and the police took a while to get there.

[00:41:22] In fact, I saw a bumper sticker at one point at a gun show that said, depending upon the police to protect your family is like depending upon the dentist to brush your teeth. The dentist knows more about caring for my teeth than I do, but I'm going to go ahead and brush my own. Now, let's contrast Charles Stedman Spinagel to the case of Troy George Skinner, a resident of New Zealand who met a 14-year-old 56th District girl on the Internet and traveled to the United States where he immediately purchased a lot of weapons that weren't banned by you guys, like mace and a taser and duct tape, and then went to the home of a 14-year-old girl and attempted to smash in the front door with a cinder block.

[00:42:00] Mom immediately dialed 911, but they weren't there in time. Do you know what happened next? She used a semi-automatic firearm to dispatch Mr. Skinner with two effective shots to the throat. Good for her. And she didn't have to get permission from the government to do that.

[00:42:16] So if we acknowledge that the most commonly used patrol handgun and the most commonly used patrol rifle by law enforcement are necessary to confront danger and evil for our law enforcement to be able to defend themselves, and if they get there in time, defend us, does it not logically flow from that as the court ruled in heller that we have the god-given right to defend ourselves and if you arrive at any answer other than yes then i would love to sit down and understand how when you wake up in the bed from the bed in the morning that something

[00:42:52] terrible is going to happen there is not a notice that it will happen that day if there was the police would always be there before it happened but tragically that is not the world in which we live. But what about high capacity magazines? Google search home invasions. Invasion gangs typically consist of eight to 12 individuals who by force enter a home. There are horrific stories that I dare not tell on this floor, particularly with children present. It strikes me that our

[00:43:25] lust and zeal to control the rights and freedoms of others at their peril is a manifestation on its face of tyranny. That it is not my job to tell you what is right for you, but so too, it is not your job to tell me what is right for me. So act as it may, Mr. Speaker, this General Assembly can do as it wishes. But Virginians born free and endowed by their creator with inalienable rights will continue to exercise those rights. And I fear that I will once again have the opportunity to say I told you so when your tyrannical overreach is overruled. Thank you.

[00:44:07] Clerk will call the calendar. Calendar for today, Tuesday, excuse me, Monday, June 29th, for the Virginia House of Delegates. Page 1 of the printed calendar, memorial resolutions laid on the table. The memorial resolutions to be adopted in block are listed on pages 1 and 2, with the exception of House Resolution 2195, which has already been dispensed with.

[00:44:31] Does any member request to take a resolution out of the block? Hearing none, all those in favor of adopting the memorial resolutions laid on the speaker's table as listed on pages 1 and 2, with the exception of House Resolution 2095, shall please rise.

[00:44:53] The resolution is agreed to. Continuing with the calendar, page 2, committing resolutions laid on the Speaker's table. The committing resolutions we adopted in block are listed on page 2, and they are now before you.

[00:45:09] Does any member request to remove a resolution from the block? Mr. Speaker, I apologize. And after the deadline, Mr. Speaker, the 6th, the 5th on block written on page 2, And then there are two additional ones, House Resolution 2206 and 2207, which are also in the block and loaded into IHOT as well.

[00:45:31] I apologize. All those in favor of adopting the commending resolutions laid on the speaker's table found on pages 1 with the addition of those as announced by the clerk shall say aye. All those opposed no, the resolutions are agreed to. And continuing with the counter on page 3, we come to the category House Bill with Recommendation by the Governor.

[00:45:51] There is one measure, House Bill 30, for all appropriations of the budget and provide a portion of revenues for the two years ending respectively on the 30th day of June 2027 and the 30th day of June 2028 to amend and reenact portions of the code and repeal portions of the Acts of Assembly of 2022, effective for taxable years beginning on and after January 1, 2027.

[00:46:13] The governor has sent down a total of 14 amendments, and by custom and practice of that body, we would do those in a block. Those amendments are now before you. Delegate from Alexandria,

Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a request. The delegate has the floor.

[00:46:29] Mr. Speaker, I request that we sever governor amendments number 3 on page 5, amendment 4 on page 6, and amendment 5 on page 7, and take those up together in a block. Without objection.

[00:46:51] No. But out of objection. The delegate from Prince William, Delegatorian, I guess you would speak to those three, four, and five first, and then you can speak to the other one as you need to.

[00:47:09] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, we all have the information before us, and we're ready to vote. So do you move the amendment, sir? I move the amendment. Shall the amendments be agreed to? Circle, close the roll.

[00:47:36] Ayes, 88, noes, 0. Ayes 88, noes 0, amendments 3, 4, and 5 are adopted. So, Ms. Speaker, now we'll work our way through the remaining 11 amendments, take them in numeric order. So, we now have before the body Amendment 1, providing for additional cost of referendums.

[00:47:58] It is Item 77. It's available on IHOD to the public. It is now before the body. Delegate from Prince William, Delegatory. Ms. Speaker, I move the amendment. Shall the amendment be adopted? Ms. Speaker.

[00:48:19] Yes, Speaker. Is this number one? This is Amendment 1. Okay, yes. Mr. Speaker, just briefly. You would like to speak to the amendment? Just briefly. Okay. Trick or destroy the roll? Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Yeah, Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, I would encourage a no vote on this.

[00:48:38] This is the referendum, executing the referendums that are coming up for a vote this year, and I would encourage a no vote. Madam Clerk, are you ready? You ready? Shall Amendment 1 be agreed to?

[00:49:04] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 57, noes 33. I-57, Nose 33, Amendment 1 is adopted. Mr. Speaker, point of order. The delegate has the floor.

[00:49:20] Mr. Speaker, I'm not meaning to slow down the train, but when the clerk reads, say, Amendment 2, could you just say support Atlantic Manhattan Research for those who are not following along in the book? We're happy to accommodate you, Delegate Kilgore.

[00:49:38] For those who are not reading along, the clerk will read it. The clerk will read it for you. There you go. Page three of today's calendar, amendment number two of the governor's amendments, which be characterized as supporting the Atlantic Menhaden research, that is item 145.

[00:49:56] It's available to the public, to the members, and is now before the body. The delegate from Press William, Delegatorian. Mr. Speaker, I move the amendment. Shall the amendment be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:50:17] Ayes 65, nos 25. Ayes 65, nos 25. The amendment is adopted. Continuing to work through the governor's amendments, we come to Amendment No. 6 on page 8.

[00:50:34] Amendment No. 6, which seeks to expand a RGGI utility credit to Virginia cooperatives and clarify credit eligibility. That is Item 367, available to the public and to the members presently, so it's before you now. The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore.

[00:50:50] Mr. Speaker, speak to the amendment. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen, I get up all the time and talk about RGGI, and I'm glad that the governor included the

cooperatives. We appreciate that, those of us who have cooperatives in our region.

[00:51:07] But one thing that we are seeing here, that the power bills are now going to have the credit on RGGI, but it's not necessarily going to have what RGGI costs. So the credit gets a level, but the cost doesn't get a level.

[00:51:22] That seems to be a little bit of a slot of hand there. So, you know, we all need to work as we move forward next year and the years after to make our electric bills more transparent. I think we just need to continue to make our electric bills more transparent because folks ask, hey, what's this charge?

[00:51:43] What's this charge? And we just need to work as a body to make those transparent. So, Mr. Speaker, thank you for allowing me to speak to this amendment. Shall the governor's amendment be adopted? It is 6.1.

[00:52:02] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, on amendment 6.1, the ayes are 65, noes are 23. Ayes 65, noes 23. The amendment is adopted. Continuing with the governor's amendments, we come to amendment number 7 on page 9 of the printing calendar, if you're following that way.

[00:52:22] Amendment 7 regards facial coverings, law enforcement. It is item 391. Amendment is available to the public, to the members, and is now before the body. The delegate from Campbell County, delegate there. Mr. Speaker, I'd like to speak to this amendment.

[00:52:38] The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, as one of our former colleagues used to say, this body passes laws, not ideas. And this amendment is what happens when we forget that. Majority passed legislation restricting when law enforcement officers may wear facial coverings while performing their duties.

[00:52:53] The obvious target is federal immigration enforcement. The federal government has already sued Virginia over that issue. But the law also reaches Virginia law enforcement officers. And as you move from a political talking point to an actual statute, details matter.

[00:53:10] Who's undercover? Who's assigned to a drug unit? Who's conducting surveillance? Who's working gang enforcement? Who's protecting a public official? Who needs to conceal his identity today so that he can do his job safely tomorrow? These are not academic questions. These are operational questions.

[00:53:26] And if we get them wrong, people get hurt. That is why this amendment is before us. it clarifies that officers assigned to SWAT or specialized tactical teams, undercover units, drug units, gang units, executive protection or surveillance operations are not caught in a rule that could expose their identity and compromise their safety.

[00:53:45] Mr. Speaker, this is not a college seminar. It's not an activist panel. This is governance. We have an obligation to write laws that work in the real world, not just laws that sound good in a press release. When this body passes ideas instead of laws, we end up back here fixing avoidable mistakes.

[00:54:03] This amendment's here because the original bill was written sloppily and in haste. Let this lesson be remembered the next time a half-baked bill comes through this chamber. Thank you. Shall Amendment 7 be adopted?

[00:54:33] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, nos 24. Ayes 63, nos 24. The governor's Amendment 7 is adopted. Over on page 10 of the printing calendar, we come to Amendment 8 by Her Excellency. This one

relates to establishing the Firefighter Cancer Screening Grant Program, which is item 406 in the budget.

[00:54:54] It is available to the public, to the members, and it is now before you. Delegate from Washington County, Delegate O'Quinn. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking of the amendment. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So, I rise in support of this amendment. I represent the City of Bristol, which has a professional fire department, and the men and women in that department do phenomenal work.

[00:55:15] The only thing that I would raise on this is that, particularly in rural areas and some suburban areas, we have a lot of volunteer firefighters. And a fire is a fire, and professional departments run a lot more calls, but volunteer firefighters are also exposed to the same chemicals, the same toxins, and I would hope that going forward that we can figure out a way to possibly expand this to volunteer firefighters as well.

[00:55:40] However, when it comes to a simple decision of covering more firefighters or not, I'm in support of it. So thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the governor's amendment number eight be adopted?

[00:56:03] Close the roll. Ayes, 90, no, zero. Ayes, 90, no, zero. The governor's amendment number eight is adopted. Page 11 of the printed calendar, we come to amendment nine, which provides funding for a digital services team. This is item 471 in the budget.

[00:56:20] The amendment is available to the public, to the members, and is before you. The Delegate for Prince William, Delegate Torian. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move the adoption of the governor's amendment. Shall the governor's amendment number 9 be agreed to? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:56:47] Ayes 62, nos 28. Ayes 62, nos 28. The governor's amendment is adopted. Continuing with governor's amendments over on page 12 of the printed calendar, we come to amendment number 10 by the governor relating to acquisition of Oak Hill Farm.

[00:57:03] This is Item C-15. It is available to the public, to the members. It is now before you. Delegate from President William, Delegate Torrey. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the Governor's Amendment. Delegate from Farquhar County, Delegate McAuliffe. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the Amendment. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. In a few days, we will celebrate the 250th anniversary of our great nation.

[00:57:25] And when we leave today, we're going to go to all the corners of our Commonwealth to celebrate those who sacrificed their lives so that we may build a government of, by, and for the people. So today, I am asking that we vote to preserve 1,250 acres of farm and forest land and the last Founding Fathers' home in private hands and share it with Virginians at absolutely no cost to the Commonwealth.

[00:57:51] By voting yes today, we must both acknowledge that sacrifice and acknowledge that our Founding Fathers failed to fully live up to the promise that they made in fighting for a free and democratic nation. But future generations took up that fight over the past 250 years to build a more equal nation and we all in this room still strive for those goals today.

[00:58:13] So the language before you accepts the property and puts it on the path to becoming a state park, giving both the House and the Senate continued oversight and authority to direct the way that history is shared. So I ask you to join me in voting yes today to ensure that at our 300th anniversary I can use my hovercraft AI powered wheelchair to visit Oak Hill State Park and I hope you

[00:58:34] join me. Thank you. Shall amendment 10 be adopted? Clerk will close the call. Ayes. 74, noes 14.

[00:58:58] 74, noes 14. Amendment 10 is adopted. Continuing with governor's amendment page 14 of the printed calendar, we come to amendment number 11, a technical amendment relating to data center electricity consumption tax technical adjustments. This is item 3-5.24. It's available to the public, to the members, and is now before you. Delegate from Prince William, delegatorian.

[00:59:22] Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the Governor's Amendment. Shall the amendment be adopted?

[00:59:40] Ayes, 76, nos, 9. Ayes, 76, nos, 9. The Governor's Amendment is adopted. Page 15 of the print calendar, we come to Amendment 12, which relates to additional local sales tax referendum timing and other technical corrections.

[00:59:56] This is Item 4-14. It's available to the public, to the members, and it's before you. Delegate for Prince William, Delegatory. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the Governor's Amendment.

[01:00:04] shall the governor's amendment be adopted number 12 circle close the row ayes 62 knows 28 ayes 62

[01:00:47] knows 28 the governor's amendment number 12 is adopted over on page 16 we come to amendment number 13 by the governor relating to a paid sick leave this is item 4-14 in house bill 30 it's available to the public members and is now uh before the house delegate for press Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the Governor's Amendment.

[01:01:10] Shall Amendment 13 be adopted?

[01:01:22] Clerk will close. Ayes, 57, noes, 33. Ayes, 57, noes, 33. Amendment 13 is adopted. And finally, we come to page 19 of today's calendar. The last amendment to be considered is Amendment No. 14 relating to possession of firearms in public areas, delayed enactment.

[01:01:41] This is Item 4-14. It's a language amendment. It's available to the public, to the members. It is now before you. Delegate from Prince William, Delegatorian. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the governor's amendment. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the amendment. The delegate has the floor.

[01:01:57] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Let me tell you what really happened here. We passed a bill that was an idea, not a bill. There were no guts in it that actually functioned within the realm of jurisprudence in the United States. And the downstream consequences were either not contemplated or contemplated nefariously.

[01:02:14] This is ultimately a backdoor war on private security. And I will bring up Amin Abdullah, who was a security guard at the San Diego Mosque, where two hate-filled young people with nihilist ideals were stopped by a 51-year-old father-of-eight private security guard who this very bill would prevent from doing his job.

[01:02:32] I could bring up the Michigan synagogue and school shooting this same year, where private security wouldn't have been able to do their job. I have been hearing from people from across this commonwealth, particularly northern Virginia, where there are individuals tasked with protecting

individuals in mosques and synagogues specifically, but not exclusively, who, if this passes, can't do their jobs.

[01:02:50] So now there's a, well, it's going to be delayed for a year. Shouldn't you vote for it? No, what should happen is we shouldn't pass bills that are back doors defunding the police because there are three private security guards for every one paid law enforcement professional. We shouldn't pass bills that defund SROs. We shouldn't pass bills that put any of our children at greater risk to virtue signal to constituencies who don't understand the reality of the world in which sometimes evil comes and knocks on your door unexpected.

[01:03:16] And so we can kick this can down the road or we can do it the right way and not promulgate laws that disarm the most vulnerable among us. I would encourage a no vote. I would encourage us to do a little bit more than just delay the enactment, but instead strike legislation that will literally cost the lives of the most vulnerable among us here in the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[01:03:35] Thank you. Shall the amendment be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:03:54] Ayes 56, noes 34. Ayes 56, noes 34. The amendment is adopted. Ms. Speaker, so that completes work on today's calendar. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House stand in recess pursuant to the provisions of H.R. 2069.

[01:04:15] The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the House stand in recess pursuant to the provisions of House Resolution 2069. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to.

[01:04:31] The House stands in recess pursuant to the provisions of House Resolution 2069. See ya. I'm back.

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